Merinos & Matagouri by Moonlight.

Dec 1st & 2nd 2001

Please pass this around your team members.

Acknowledgments.

The farmers for the opportunity to hold this event on their properties.

Stronsay, Ross & Chris Beech (control numbers 10,36,61,41, the woolshed, water supply, cottage for organisers & paddock for camping)
Awapiri, Graham & Bev Black (100,71,90)
Mt Carmel, Lyall Barriball & Rachel Smith (62,63,42,51)
Duntroon, Robert & Trish Oswald (80,48,32,49)
Welds Hill, Godfrey & Laurene Checkley (81,43,72,52)
Awatere Downs (Tinline Downs on map) Chris Richards & Janna Greene (23,22,64,30,90)
Ballochdale, Gary & Sara Neill (92)
Medway Hills, Peter & Junette Molineux (34,44,54,45,66)
Corleggy, Brian & Rowena Allan (65,55,50,53,74)
Upton Fells, Kit & Margie Sandall (102,75,21,82,46,24,12,70)
Glen Orkney, Simon & Lynda Harvey (20,40,31,57,47,76,101)

Also

Marlborough Mussel Co Ltd
For a great deal of photocopying.

Montana Wines Ltd
For a dozen bottles of wine for the farmers.

Selwyn Law
For the cartoons.

The Seddon school catering group
For the food during the night and the meal afterwards.

PAPO for the punches.
Marlb. Harriers for the sound system.
Rod McCloy for helping with the tents & lights.
Marg King, Jenny Maclaren & Colin Hope for help at the finish.
Russell Lundon for patrolling the road.
Malcolm Brennan for being ready at the end to go looking for teams.

Finally the competitors, for without you there would be no event.

Routes.

Team 31 1st M 1st Open
11,23,81,43,72,52,91,30,64,66,44,34,92,53,54,45,50,65,102,75,55,74,82,21,home for food,20,60,40,31,57,41,61,36,10,finish.
Team 3 1st MV 4th Open
36,61,49,32,80,48,63,90,71,62,42,51,100,57,47,101,76,70,12,24,75,55,74,82,21,finish.
Team 2 1st X 1st SV 8th Open
10,36,49,80,63,90,71,62,51,100,57,76,101 not found,70,12,24,46,74,55,65,50,53,92,34,finish.
Team 24 1st W 13th Open
11,23,43,72,52,91,30,64,66,54,44,92,53,45,50,65,102 not found,55,74,82,46,24,12,70,finish.
Team 56 1st N 6th Open
21,82,74,55,102,75,46,24,12,70,56,101,76,47,60,home for food & rest,22,64,66,54,44,92,53,50,45,home again!,11,23,finish.
Team 13 2nd W, 2nd N
20,60,70,12,24,46,74,55,65,50,45,53,92,34,66,30 not found,91,52,72,43,81,23,11,finish.

Commentary by Susan.

You will all be well recovered from your exertions in the Medway Valley by the time you read this, and I hope that you have been studying the map, thinking about what you did, what you didn't do, and perhaps what you should have done! Here are some of my thoughts.

Planning beforehand. A well laid out rogaining map should never offer an obvious answer to "what is the best route?", whatever your ambitions as a competitor. So…

- Did you notice that the points were evenly distributed over the map? Each quarter of the map offered the same number of points.
- Did you notice that the three 100 point controls all required careful navigation (they were all "red" controls in orienteering terms), and all three 90 pointers were easy to find (they were all "yellow" in orienteering terms). This means that the 100s would be very hard to find in the dark, and the 90s would all be relatively easy. Did you think about that?
- Did you measure the control circles and note that they are 6mm = 300m across? The control is in the centre, so it is 150m from the edge of the circle (scale 1:50,000 means 100m on the ground = 2mm on the map).The circle edge can be a distance guide as you approach the control.
- Did you look for clear **attack points** for each control you were visiting? e.g. a corner in a road makes a good attack point. (for the non-orienteers, an attack point is a clear, easy to find feature handy to your control – you navigate carefully from your attack point). E.g. for 101, the nearest good attack point is the saddle that the road passes through to the south west of point 1019. For 46, the top of the hill 839m is your attack point, for control 60, the fence junction, and so on.
- Did you look for **catching features** for your controls? Something you will easily recognise that tells you that you have gone past your control site. Line features like creeks, fences and roads make good catching features. For control 101, the flat topped spur running east/west from point 1019 is a very helpful catching feature (or attack point if you were approaching from 56)
- Did you count contours between controls? At least one team climbed from 82 up to 46, a climb of 360 vertical metres. Was it worth the effort?
- Did you weigh up route choices between controls, looking for the most efficient order for groups of controls?
- Did you measure the straight line distances between the controls on your planned route? Did you work out roughly where you were likely to be when it got dark, and therefore which controls you would be trying to find in the dark?
- Unless you are experienced navigators on a 1:50,000 map in totally unfamiliar terrain in the dark, you should have been aiming to look for EASY controls during darkness. Easy = good attack points, close to the control, or controls on easy to identify features: 70, 12, 24, 46, 74, 55, 65 etc.
- As is required for orienteering, every control was on a feature marked on the map: if the control description said "gully" or " spur" then that gully or spur was big enough to be marked on the map. The smaller folds in the land don't appear on the map contour lines because the 1:50,000 scale is too small.
- Did you consider the option of coming back to the event centre during the night for food, to read the map and to review your plan in good lighting? The winning team spent about half an hour at the woolshed having soup and cheese toasties and planning their "second half". About half of all the competitors came back during the night, some only for food, some for food and sleep.
- Do you see why we gave you 3 hours to plan? Did you make the most of that time, while you were fresh, the map was easy to read (good light, no sweat in the eyes or rain on the plastic bag)?

We heard lots of comments about teams not being able to find controls even though they were sure that THEY were in the right place, and they looked for "hours", so we heard. If you think you are in the right place/on the right feature, and about the right altitude, and you spend more than a few minutes looking for a control and can't find it, then YOU are NOT in the right place!!!! You need to relocate (another orienteering term) yourself back to a recognisable feature and try again. Or give up on that control. A rogaine is about navigating using a map, it is NOT a treasure hunt where you cast about the countryside hunting for control flags, and if you are lucky you find one!!! Interestingly, for every team that swore the control flag was "not there", or "too hard", there was another team who said, "we had no trouble finding it".

Comments from competitors.

"We found the event demanding both physically and navigationally, the latter being made more so by the lack of moon and the general weather at times during the night. A good testing event!!!"
The Oldies (team 2 XSV)

"Could have been 24hrs……."
"I think that (a) some flags were difficult to find but (b) that is always the case particularly at night and therefore you do have to navigate correctly to the feature before you start casting around."
"…….never dreamt of beating some of my old rivals!"
"*Distance of 56km is pleasing, I was thinking 50-55km might be our lot, and that was before I saw the steepness of the hills!"*
Michael Wood (team 3 MV)

"No trouble finding 101 in the dark."
Julian Maclaren (team 32 M)

" We both enjoyed it, even Katie who originally thought she would not be able to do as much walking as we eventually achieved. The course was challenging, and we both learnt lots. We will try again next year, or whenever someone else organises one reasonably close to Wellington."
James Scott (team 33 XFN)

"Don't ring me, I'll ring you."
Maurice Brown (team 57 MV)

"I have never sworn so much in my life."
Gillian McCloy (team 16 XN)

"We certainly found the course a challenge, especially the route planning, no really obvious loop which left a great deal of choice."
Chris Byrch (team 24 W)

"My first rogaine, alot harder than expected especially the night navigation.
Will be back in two years, give us plenty of time to work on those planning and navigation skills."
Brian Goodes (team 71 MN)

"…enjoyed the challenging terrain and the opportunity to see some unique NZ country-side."
Dorothy & Neil Kane (team 36 MV)

"…..had a great time, and I am richer for the experience, I look forward to the next Rogaine going."
Chris James (team 64 MVN)

"…..all the controls were in the right place, and everyone seemed to have a great time."
Nigel Corry (team 56 MN)

"….my knee unfortunately is badly twisted and I won't know how bad until the swelling goes down. Hopefully not too bad…."
"……looking forward to another one when I recover."
"Could you thank the farm owners who came to get us for me as I am not sure of their names, it was greatly appreciated."
Sharon Adamson (team 17 WV)

"The drive in was nice."
Mondo Kopua (team 9 M)

"Like to do it again"
Julie Saul (team 12 WVN)

"Bugger"
Barry "40 stitches" Hope (team 8 MV) as he ripped his leg open on a barbed wire fence at 61.

Apologies to anyone I have misquoted.

Results.

Place	Team No.	Grade	Names	Points Collected	Penalty	Total		Finish time
1	31	M	Chris Forne, Matthias Retter & Hamish Kenneally	1650		1650	1st M	9:45
2	66	M	Phil Wood & Darren Ashmore	1640		1640	2nd M	9:56
3	42	M	Tony LeSueur & Warren LeSueur	1480		1480	3rd M	9:33
4	3	MV	Michael Wood & David King	1400		1400	1st MV	9:49
5	22	MV	Chris Tait & Tony Gazley	1380	20	1360	2nd MV	10:02
6	56	MN	Al Cross & Nigel Corry	1340		1340	1st N	9:48
7	55	M	Rob Jessop & Mark Lawson	1260		1260		7:04
8	2	XSV	Peter Squires, Anne Kennedy & Bill Kennedy	1250		1250	1st X, 1st SV	9:36
9	37	M	Andy Rhodes & Bruce McBride	1250		1250		9:47
10	32	M	Julian Maclaren, Michael Smithson & Joe Jagusch	1310	80	1230		10:08
11	10	M	Luke Paardekooper & Ross Barnes	1160		1160		9:49
12	18	MV	Mike Sheridon & Allan Stowell	1160		1160	3rd MV	9:54
13	24	W	Chris Byrch & Ali Bell	1150		1150	1st W	9:54
14	13	WN	Jenny Biddulph, Jane Mitchell & Sandra Steingrimsson	1120		1120	2nd W, 2nd N	9:21
15	23	W	Rachel Smith & Rebecca Smith	1110		1110	3rd W	7:21
16	51	MF	Des O'Regan & Duncan O'Regan	1100		1100	1st F	9:53
17	4	MV	Dave Laurie & Tom Bamfield	1090		1090		9:26
18	48	M	Ramash Swamy, Mark Anderson & Chris Short	1060		1060		9:17
19	62	M	Paul Stenhouse & Mark Lewis	1070	20	1050		10:02
20	5	X	Warren McKie & Kath Copland	970		970	2nd X	9:30
21	16	XN	Richard Law & Gillian McCloy	920		920	3rd X, 3rd N	9:12
22	47	X	Bob Cunninghame, Franciesca Cunninghame, Julie Grant & Melanie Stephen	900		900		8:42
23	46	MV	Neil Higgins, Cliff Jones, Rod Smillie & Ian Marshell	820		820		8:48
24	25	W	Linda Lilburne & Heather North	980	170	810		10:17
25	21	M	Alan Stow & Ron Rumbal	770		770		9:28
26	54	X	Janet Wilson, Graham Peters & Yvette Cottam	760		760		9:36
27	20	XV	Annie Sanderson & Nick Collins	750		750	1st XV	3:15
28	39	M	Mark Botting, Chris Muller & Pat McLarin	730		730		9:09
29	19	MV	Mark Wheeler & Alan Wilson	730		730		9:28
30	61	M	Phil Bones, Dave Wall, David Bones & Alastair Wall	720		720		7:42
31	41	M	Doug Walsh & Mike Walsh	720		720		9:33
32	68	XV	Liz Nicholson & Jim Alpe	720		720	2nd XV	9:39
33	14	M	Steven Knowles & Malcolm Chiles	710		710		2:25
34	64	MVN	Chris James, Tony Reidie & Peter Young	710		710		4:03
35	15	X	Paul Abbott, Fiona Pratt, Dan Rhodes & Rachel Dawber	700		700		9:38

Results continued.

36	43	XF	Pat Bodger, Kate Bodger & Frances Bodger	670		670	2nd F	9:12
37	36	XV	Dorothy Kane & Neil Kane	670		670	3rd XV	9:37
38	63	XN	Helen Chapman & Gary Smith	660		660		9:53
39	8	MV	Barry Hope & Colin Hope	650		650		2:26
40	9	M	Team Mondo Enterprises - Mondo Kopua & Jut Bishop	640		640		7:48
41	26	XV	Lesley Woudberg & Jac Woudberg	630		630		8:51
42	52	MN	Russell Nicholls & Phillip Nicholls	590		590		4:15
43	60	X	Sarah Underwood & William Power	580		580		1:47
44	50	X	Charlie Hand, Carol Hand, John Hayes & Megan Watson	580		580		8:24
45	65	WV	Pam Whitla & Kathrin Mueller	570		570	1st WV	9:30
46	59	MN	Fergus McConnell & Grant Allan	530		530		9:37
47	57	MV	Maurice Brown, Allistair Christie & Trevor Merrifield	530		530		9:41
48	27	WV	Wendy Nelson & Lisa Pilkington	520		520	2nd WV	9:46
49	34	M	Alan Lowrie & Mike Lowrie	510		510		5:20
50	71	MN	Roger Martin & Brian Goodes	500		500		3:30
51	69	MN	Kyle Christensen & Mark Preece	500		500		7:14
52	33	XFN	James Scott & Katie Scott	490		490	3rd F	9:35
53	1	X	Andreas Kubisch & Rainer Huber	470		470		9:35
54	11	XN	Andrew Robbie, Peter Campbell & Jenny Campbell	450		450		7:27
55	38	MN	Barry Moore & Shawn Black	440		440		7:47
56	53	M	Richard Hobbs, Lyndon Paynter & Tim Hartnell	400		400		1:55
57	29	M	Clive Marsh & Ross McLean	380		380		9:18
58	58	XN	Graeme Ellis, Jessica Ellis, Mike Ferguson, Reuben Ferguson, & Emma Ferguson	350		350		8:48
59	45	XJN	Frith Dollimore, Ben Irving, Steph Kerr & Sam Reed	350		350	1st J	9:09
60	28	M	Varian Wilson & Nick Boniface	290		290		3:35
61	12	WVN	Julie Saul & Penny Dollimore	290		290	3rd WV	9:11
62	44	WVN	Nicky Bodger & Frances Wall	230		230		2:50
63	30	M	Kalle Pokkinen, Brent Adcock & John Veal	200		200		12:10
64	40	XVN	Jane Minto & Colin Findlay	150		150		9:49
65	6	WN	Kate Batten & Katie Rattray	140		140		21:30
66	67	WN	Mea Ivory & Sue McFadgen	140		140		22:45
67	35	XV	Irene Pow & Marcus King	750	750	0	Late	10:56
68	17	WV	Hilary Frewin & Sharon Adamson	110		DNF	Withdrawn	
69	7	X	Maureen McCloy & Mike Flaws			DNS		
70	49	XV	Linda Mead & Derek Mead			DNS		

The last word by Alan

The best performance? Must go to the novice team (13) of Jenny Biddulph, Jane Mitchell & Sandra Steingrimsson (2nd W, 2nd N & 14th overall). Closely followed by team 51 Des & Duncan (13 years old) O'Regan (1st Family &16th overall).

Special acknowledgment must go to Susan King & my family Janette, Richard & Robbie for all their hard work.

Rogaining is a tough sport, both physically & mentally. There is so much to putting together a top performance. See you at the next one wherever it is.

Over & out!